

Face Shape Types

A practical guide to identifying face shape through measurement and proportion

How to Measure Your Face

Use a flexible tape measure or ruler. Pull hair back, face a mirror straight-on, and keep the tape level for each reading. Record all four measurements below in the same units (inches or centimeters) before comparing ratios.

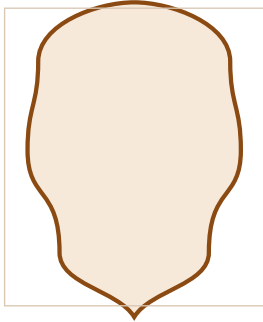
Measurement	How to Measure
Face Length	Measure from the center of the hairline straight down to the tip of the chin.
Forehead Width	Measure straight across the widest part of the forehead, roughly from temple to temple, at the level just above the eyebrows.
Cheekbone Width	Measure across the face at the highest, widest point of the cheekbones (just below the outer corner of each eye).
Jawline Width	Measure from one corner of the jaw to the other, about an inch below the ears, following the angle of the jaw.
Jaw Length	Measure along the jaw from the corner (below the ear) to the tip of the chin, then double it for full jaw span if needed.

Tip: Once you have all four widths plus face length, compare them side by side. The shape category is decided by which measurements are closest in size and which is clearly the largest or smallest.

Quick Ratio Reference

Shape	Length vs. Width	Widest Point	Jawline
Oval	Length $\approx$ 1.5x width	Cheekbones	Softly rounded, narrower than cheekbones
Round	Length $\approx$ width	Cheekbones	Rounded, soft, no sharp angles
Square	Length $\approx$ width	Jaw $\approx$ forehead $\approx$ cheekbones	Strong, angular, roughly same width as forehead
Heart	Length > width	Forehead	Narrow, pointed chin
Diamond	Length > width	Cheekbones (narrow forehead & jaw)	Narrow, pointed chin
Oblong / Rectangle	Length notably > width	Even forehead/cheek/jaw width	Straighter, longer than square
Triangle (Pear)	Length > width	Jawline	Wide jaw, narrower forehead

Face Shapes in Detail

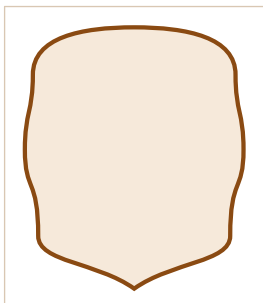


Oval

Defining ratio: Face length $\approx$ 1.5x the cheekbone width; cheekbones are the widest point.

- Forehead is slightly wider than the jaw, with a gently rounded hairline.
- Jaw is narrower than the cheekbones and softly curved rather than angular.
- Face gradually narrows from cheekbones down to a rounded chin.

Styling note: Considered the most balanced/versatile shape; most frames and hairstyles suit it well.

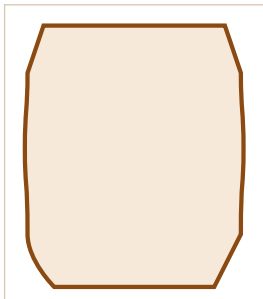


Round

Defining ratio: Face length $\approx$ face width; cheekbones and face width are nearly equal.

- Forehead, cheekbones, and jaw are all similar in width.
- Jawline is soft and rounded with no defined angles.
- Cheeks are often the fullest part of the face.

Styling note: Angular accessories and hairstyles with height on top help add visual length.

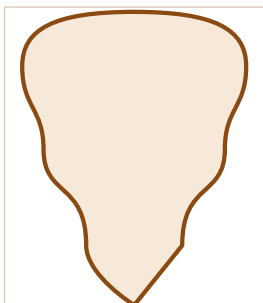


Square

Defining ratio: Forehead width $\approx$ cheekbone width $\approx$ jaw width; length is close to width.

- Jawline is strong, angular, and roughly as wide as the forehead.
- Hairline is often straight rather than curved.
- Sides of the face are relatively straight, with minimal tapering.

Styling note: Soft, rounded lines in hairstyles or frames balance the strong jaw.

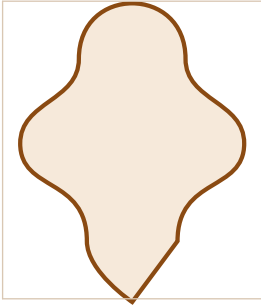


Heart

Defining ratio: Forehead is the widest measurement; jaw is noticeably narrower.

- Forehead and cheekbones are wide relative to a narrow, often pointed chin.
- Hairline may have a slight widow's peak.
- Face tapers steadily from temples down to the chin.

Styling note: Styles that add width near the jaw help balance a broader forehead.

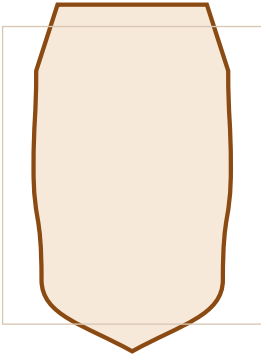


Diamond

Defining ratio: Cheekbones are the widest point; forehead and jaw are both narrower and similar in width.

- Forehead is narrow, widening sharply at the cheekbones, then narrowing to the chin.
- Chin is often pointed.
- Cheekbones may appear high and prominent.

Styling note: Styles that soften the cheekbone width and add fullness at the forehead or jaw work well.

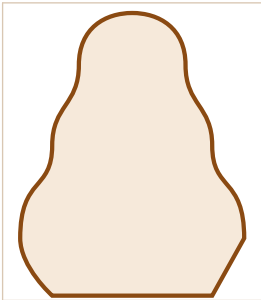


Oblong / Rectangle

Defining ratio: Face length is notably greater than width (roughly 1.5x or more); forehead, cheek, and jaw widths are similar.

- Face is longer than it is wide, with fairly straight, parallel sides.
- Forehead, cheekbones, and jaw are similar in width, unlike an oval.
- Jaw can be straight or gently rounded.

Styling note: Hairstyles with width (rather than added height) help shorten the visual length.



Triangle (Pear)

Defining ratio: Jawline is the widest measurement; forehead is the narrowest.

- Jaw is wider than the cheekbones and forehead.
- Forehead is comparatively narrow.
- Face widens gradually from top to bottom.

Styling note: Volume near the temples and forehead helps balance a wider jawline.

This guide is for general reference only. Face shape categories are approximations — many faces are a blend of two shapes, and that's completely normal.